

# Knowledge Base

## Automotive Parts Ordering Portal Reference Guide

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| <b>Document type</b> | Knowledge base reference document                                                  |
| <b>Coverage</b>      | Billing, delivery status, order tracking, parts catalog, pricing, and replacements |

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# 1. Billing and Invoicing

## 1.1 How Billing Works in the Parts Ordering Portal

The billing process in the automotive parts ordering portal is closely linked to the delivery process. An invoice is generated when parts are delivered and confirmed, not at the time the order is placed. This means that the invoice reflects the actual quantity of parts delivered rather than the quantity ordered, which is important in cases where an order is partially fulfilled or where some items are placed on backlog.

## 1.2 Invoice Generation

When a delivery is confirmed as received, the system triggers the invoice generation process. The invoice is created based on the delivered quantities and the prices agreed at the time of ordering. If the dealer has a contract price for a specific part, that contract price is used on the invoice. If no contract price exists, the standard list price minus any applicable discount is used. The invoice is typically available in the Billing List screen within a short time of the delivery being confirmed. Each invoice is assigned a unique invoice number that can be used for reference in all communications and for accounting purposes. The invoice shows the invoice date, the payment due date based on the agreed payment terms, the delivery reference number, all line items with part numbers, descriptions, quantities, unit prices, and line totals, and the overall invoice total including any applicable taxes.

## 1.3 Payment Terms

Payment terms are defined in the dealer contract and specify how many days after the invoice date the payment is due. Common payment terms are net 30 days or net 60 days for dealers with extended payment terms. The payment due date is shown on each invoice. Dealers should ensure that payments are made by the due date to avoid late payment charges and to maintain their credit limit in good standing.

## 1.4 Credit Notes

A credit note is a billing document that reduces the amount owed by the dealer. Credit notes are issued when a warranty claim is approved, when a damage claim is approved, when a return is processed and the returned parts are accepted, or when a billing error is identified and confirmed. Credit notes are displayed in the Billing List screen alongside invoices. Each credit note shows the credit note number, the date it was issued, the reason for the credit, the original invoice or claim reference it relates to, and the credit amount. Credit notes are typically applied against the next invoice issued to the dealer account. If the credit note value exceeds the next invoice value, the remaining credit is carried forward to subsequent invoices.

## 1.5 Reconciling Invoices

Dealers should regularly reconcile their invoices against their order and delivery records to ensure accuracy. Reconciliation involves checking that each invoice corresponds to a delivery that was actually received, that the quantities on the invoice match the quantities confirmed as received, and that the prices on the invoice match the prices agreed at the time of ordering. If a discrepancy is found during reconciliation, the dealer should raise a claim through the portal as soon as possible. If parts were invoiced but not received, a quantity discrepancy claim should be raised. If the price on the invoice is incorrect, the dealer should contact their account manager. If a part was invoiced but was damaged on arrival, a damage claim should be raised.

## 1.6 Invoice History and Archive

The Billing List screen retains a complete history of all invoices and credit notes issued to the dealer account. Users can search and filter this history by date range, document type, or document number. Older documents can be downloaded as PDF files for archiving purposes. The system retains billing documents for a minimum period as required by financial record-keeping regulations, and dealers can access this history at any time.

## **1.7 Understanding Your Account Balance**

The portal provides a summary of the dealer current account balance, which reflects the total amount outstanding across all unpaid invoices minus any unapplied credit notes. This balance is used as the basis for the credit limit check when new orders are placed. If the account balance is high relative to the credit limit, new orders may be blocked until outstanding invoices are paid. Dealers who are concerned about their account balance or credit limit should contact their account manager.

## **1.8 Disputing an Invoice**

If a dealer believes an invoice is incorrect and cannot resolve the issue through the standard claims process, they should contact the billing support team directly. The billing support team can investigate the invoice in detail and, if an error is confirmed, arrange for a corrected invoice or credit note to be issued. Invoice disputes should be raised promptly, as there are time limits on disputing invoices after they have been issued. When contacting the billing support team, the dealer should have the invoice number, order reference number, and a clear description of the discrepancy ready.

## 2. Delivery Status and Backlog Management

### 2.1 Understanding the Delivery Process

Once a spare parts order has been processed and dispatched from the warehouse, it enters the delivery phase. The logistics carrier collects the packed shipment from the warehouse and transports it to the delivery address specified in the order. The automotive parts ordering portal provides visibility into this process through the Delivery Status screen, which is updated based on information received from the carrier.

### 2.2 How Delivery Status is Updated

The portal receives delivery status updates from the logistics carrier through an automated data exchange. When the carrier scans a package at a depot, loads it onto a delivery vehicle, or completes a delivery, this information is transmitted to the portal and the delivery status is updated accordingly. Updates generally appear in the portal within a short time of the event occurring at the carrier end, though occasional delays can happen. If the status has not updated for an unusually long time, the user should check the carrier tracking system using the tracking reference number.

### 2.3 Delivery Exceptions

A delivery exception occurs when something unexpected happens during the delivery process that prevents the shipment from being delivered as planned. Common delivery exceptions include failed delivery attempts, incorrect or incomplete delivery addresses, shipments held at customs for international deliveries, damaged shipments flagged by the carrier, and adverse weather or other external factors causing delays. When a delivery exception occurs, the portal displays the exception status and a brief description of the issue. The user should take action promptly based on the exception type.

### 2.4 What is a Delivery Backlog

A delivery backlog arises when an ordered part cannot be included in the initial shipment because it is not available in sufficient stock at the time the order is processed. Rather than cancelling the unfulfilled portion of the order, the system automatically creates a backlog entry. Backlog items are managed separately from the main order and have their own tracking within the Delivery Backlog screen. Each backlog item shows the original order reference, part number, outstanding quantity, and estimated availability date.

### 2.5 Managing Backlog Items Effectively

Users with outstanding backlog items should check the Delivery Backlog screen regularly. If the estimated date changes significantly, the user may need to consider alternative sourcing options, particularly if the part is needed urgently. When a backlog item becomes available and is dispatched, the user receives a notification and the item appears in the Delivery Status screen as a new shipment. If a backlog item is no longer needed, the user can request cancellation through the portal. The cancellation request is reviewed by the warehouse team and confirmed once it is certain that the item has not already been picked and packed for dispatch.

### 2.6 Handling Unit Tracking

For larger orders, the warehouse may pack the parts into multiple handling units. A handling unit is a physical container such as a box or pallet that is assigned a unique identifier. The HU Monitor screen allows users to track individual handling units and see exactly which parts are contained in each one. Handling unit tracking is useful when an order is split across multiple packages, and the handling unit identifier can be used when contacting the carrier about a specific package.

## 2.7 Confirming Delivery

When parts are received, the user should confirm receipt through the portal as soon as possible. Confirming receipt updates the order status to delivered, starts the warranty period for the received parts, and makes it easier to raise a claim if issues are discovered. To confirm receipt, the user opens the delivery detail view in the Delivery Status screen and clicks the confirm receipt button. The user verifies quantities received for each item. If discrepancies or damage exist, these should be noted during confirmation and a claim should be raised promptly.

## 2.8 Delivery Performance Monitoring

The portal provides summary information about delivery performance that can help users identify patterns or recurring issues. Users can view statistics such as average delivery time, on-time delivery rate, and frequency of delivery exceptions. This information can support planning and discussions with the account manager about service levels.

## 3. Understanding Order Tracking

### 3.1 What is Order Tracking

Order tracking is the feature in the automotive parts ordering portal that allows dealers and service partners to monitor the progress of spare parts orders from the moment they are placed until the parts are delivered. Every order placed through the portal is assigned a unique order reference number, which can be used at any time to look up the current status and history of the order.

### 3.2 How Order Tracking Works

When an order is placed, the system creates a record for that order and assigns it an initial status. As the order moves through the fulfilment process, the status is updated automatically based on information received from the warehouse management system and the logistics carrier. These updates happen in near real time, so the status shown in the portal is generally an accurate reflection of where the order is at any given moment. The order tracking system records a timestamp for every status change, so the user can see the current status and a complete history of when each stage was reached.

### 3.3 Order Status Explanations

Received means the order has been successfully submitted and recorded in the system, but warehouse processing has not yet started. Processing means the warehouse team has started picking parts and preparing them for packing. Dispatched means all available items have been packed and handed to the logistics carrier, and a shipment tracking reference is typically available. Partially delivered means some items have been delivered while others remain outstanding, often due to backlog. Delivered means all items have been confirmed as received. Cancelled means the order was cancelled before fully processed, and the order detail view shows the cancellation reason.

### 3.4 What to Do When an Order is Delayed

If an order has been in processing status for longer than expected, the user should check whether notifications or messages are associated with the order in the order detail view. If there are no notes and the delay seems excessive, the user should contact the parts ordering support team and provide the order reference number. If an order has been dispatched but delivery is taking longer than the expected delivery date, the user should check the carrier tracking information using the tracking reference shown in the order detail view. If carrier tracking shows a problem, the user should contact the carrier directly to resolve the issue.

### 3.5 Tracking Multiple Orders

Users who place a high volume of orders can use filter and search features on the Order Tracking screen to manage their order list efficiently. Filtering by status is particularly useful for identifying orders that need attention, such as dispatched orders currently in transit or partially delivered orders with outstanding backlog items.

### 3.6 Order History

The Order Tracking screen shows orders from the current period by default. To view older orders, the user can adjust the date range filter to include earlier dates. The system retains order history for an extended period, so users can look up orders placed many months or years ago if needed. This historical data is useful when raising claims or returns, because the original order reference is required for these processes.

### 3.7 Notifications for Order Updates

The portal can send automatic notifications when order status changes. Users can configure notification preferences in account settings. Notifications can be sent for events such as order dispatched, delivery confirmed, and backlog item available. Enabling these notifications means the user does not need to actively check the portal for updates and will be alerted promptly when action may be required.

## 4. Parts Catalog, Pricing, and Replacements

### 4.1 How the Parts Catalog is Organised

The parts catalog in the automotive parts ordering portal contains all spare parts available for ordering. Parts are organised into categories based on their function and the vehicle system they belong to, including engine components, transmission parts, brake system components, suspension and steering parts, electrical components, body parts, filters and consumables, and accessories. Within each category, parts are identified by a unique part number. Each catalog record includes the part number, description, category, unit of measure, technical specifications where available, compatibility information, and current availability status.

### 4.2 Searching for Parts Effectively

The most reliable way to find a part is to search by its exact part number. Part numbers are unique identifiers and a search by part number will return the specific part or indicate that the part does not exist in the catalog. If the part number is not known, users can search by description using keywords. A keyword search returns all parts whose description contains the entered keywords. More specific keywords and category filters help narrow results.

### 4.3 Understanding Part Supersession

Part supersession occurs when a part is replaced by a newer or improved version. The original part number is retired and a new part number is assigned to the replacement part. Supersession can occur due to design improvements, regulatory compliance changes, supplier changes, or consolidation of multiple part numbers into one updated part. When a part has been superseded, the original catalog entry shows a superseded status and displays the replacement part number. The catalog will always show the current active part number, even if a chain of supersessions exists.

### 4.4 Parts Availability and Stock Levels

The availability status of a part indicates whether it can be ordered and delivered within standard lead time. In-stock means the part is available in the warehouse and can be dispatched immediately upon order processing. Limited stock means the part is available but in low quantity. On-order means the part is currently out of stock but has been ordered from the supplier and is expected to be available by the shown date. Discontinued means the part is no longer manufactured or supplied and cannot be ordered. Stock levels are updated regularly but may not always reflect real-time warehouse inventory. If a part shown as in stock is unavailable during order processing, the item will be placed on backlog and the user will be notified.

### 4.5 How Pricing is Determined

The price of a part is determined by the standard list price set by the parts supplier, dealer discount based on dealer tier and purchase volume, any negotiated contract prices, and active promotions. Dealer discounts are applied automatically so the price shown is the dealer net price rather than the list price. Contract prices override the standard discount and are applied automatically when the dealer orders those parts. Active promotions are highlighted in the price list and parts catalog.

### 4.6 Price Changes

Part prices are reviewed and updated periodically. Price changes may be driven by supplier cost changes, currency fluctuations, or commercial decisions. When a price change is scheduled, the portal may display the current price and upcoming price, along with the date from which the new price will apply.



## **4.7 Ecoline and Environmental Parts**

The portal includes a category of parts designated as ecoline or environmentally friendly parts. These parts may be manufactured using sustainable processes, contain recycled materials, or be designed to reduce environmental impact during use. Ecoline parts meet the same quality and performance standards as standard parts and are fully compatible with the vehicles they are designed for. The ecoline designation is shown clearly in the parts catalog and ordering screens.

## **4.8 Special Parts Program**

The Special Parts Program covers parts that are not part of the standard catalog but can be ordered on a special basis. These may include parts for older or rare vehicle models, parts available only in certain markets, or parts requiring special handling or storage. Ordering through the Special Parts Program typically involves longer lead times and may require additional information or approvals. Users who need a part not found in the standard catalog should contact the support team to enquire about availability through the Special Parts Program.